North American AI Challenge for Neurodiverse Learning

Business Model Canvas FILLABLE

8 Key Partners

- First Place AZ: research, feedback, first pilot
- ASU and the Spark Center: mentoring, network, credibility
- Supported-living, vocational and college disability programs: reach and paying customers
- Neurodivergent self-advocates: co-design and review
- AI and cloud providers: model and hosting
- Crisis resources (988) and local services: human support when needed

7 Key Activities

- Build and improve the app and practice scenarios
- Test with First Place residents and staff
- Safety: moderation, unsafe-message detection, privacy review
- Onboard and support partner programs
- Measure outcomes: conversations started, events attended, confidence

6 Key Resources

- Mo coach: language model, practice scenario library, safety filters
- Scenarios and feedback co-designed with neurodivergent users
- Accessible design system (themes, calm mode, plain words)
- Team: AI/engineering plus user research, design and accessibility
- Trust and research access through First Place AZ

2 Value Propositions

Practice social moments safely, then use them with real people, both new and familiar.

FOR USERS

- Mo, a calm AI buddy, plays the other person and gives kind feedback
- You choose what you want help with; Bridge adapts
- Support fades: choices, then hints, then your own words
- Tone check before sending; you decide
- Calm-down space and one-tap 'I need help' to a trusted person, plus 988
- No streaks, no guilt, no AI speaking for you
- Themes, plain words, calm mode, text size

FOR PROGRAMS

- Social practice between staff sessions
- Visible progress: brave steps, events attended, confidence check-ins

DIFFERENT FROM

Meetup, Discord, Bumble BFF (no practice or support) and skills apps (no real connection).

4 Customer Relationships

- Calm, guided 3-step setup
- Daily check-in with Mo, one consistent buddy
- User controls what a trusted person sees
- Gentle progress (brave steps, badges), never guilt
- Staff onboarding and support for partner programs
- Ongoing co-design with neurodivergent users

3 Channels

- Pilot through First Place AZ: residents, staff, social events
- Partner programs: supported living, vocational, college disability offices
- Neurodivergent communities and creators
- Mobile web app first, then app stores
- Word of mouth from families and coaches

1 Customer Segments

USERS

Neurodivergent young adults (18-30): autism, ADHD, social anxiety, building independent lives.

- Start: First Place AZ residents and alumni
- Then: people with no staffed community or organized events

Goals differ:

- meet new people
- stay close to family, roommates, coworkers
- handle tricky moments
- talk at work or school

PAYERS

- Supported-living and transition programs
- Vocational and employment services
- College disability and neurodiversity programs

ALSO INVOLVED

Trusted people (parent, coach): help in a crisis, never see chats.

9 Cost Structure

- Engineering and design time (student team keeps early costs low)
- AI model use: grows with active users
- Hosting, security and privacy compliance
- Safety moderation and ethics/privacy review
- Writing and testing practice scenarios
- Pilot and partner support

5 Revenue Streams

- Free core app for individuals, so cost is never a barrier
- Program licenses: per-seat annual pricing for supported-living, vocational and college programs (price tested in the pilot)
- Grants and innovation funding: disability inclusion, workforce and education
- Later: optional family plan with extra check-in and safety features

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